Collection Process



Boarding arrangements - preparation



- Once we send you a collection request, please contact the given agents at said for the firm vessel schedule and boarding arrangements. Keep close contact until boarding time.
- In case, there are some specific requirements for boarding as the port agents/authorities, please relay the information to us in order to seek approval of any charges from the owners if required. Also submit/carry the valid ID/documents in case required for the boarding formalities.
- Collector should board the vessel at berth on arrival so as to avoid any miss out on the collection.
- Please follow our collection instructions in case any specific instructions given for each vessel.
- Contact FedEx / DHL or any other Logistics responsible for shipping out the samples to our designated laboratory to ensure that the samples can be dispatched
- As the nature of the testing is unannounced, it is imperative the vessel is not aware about the collector boarding, so relay this information to the agents as well.

Collection process - preparation

Please carry 30-35 kits on board the vessel for collection along with the same amount of COC forms/Mou forms in case the crew member are around 25 on board.

We request to confirm once with the agents the number of crew numbers on board in order to be sure to carry sufficient amount of kits/forms for sampling purpose.

Please print and carry all the necessary paperwork like the Letter to Master, Authorisation letter, Coc forms/ MOU forms.

In case of few Clients request, there would be some additional documents we require to carry on board, in order to suffice on board so that the vessel/Master can understand the purpose of visit on board. E.g., Official Request mail, Owners permission Letter, Clients Health declaration form (duly filed & signed by the collector.

Please carry the tamper seals required to seal the samples once collected from respective crew members

In some cases, Client request to conduct RTPCR or ART test and submit it with the health declaration letter and send to us prior the collector boarding.



Breath Alcohol Testing

- Please carry the breath testing device if we have provided from our end, otherwise there will be a device available on board for the testing.
- Please ensure you have completed the training module for the ‘Breath Alcohol Test’ and an acknowledgement of your assessment from us in case you are using our breath testing device
- Most of our Clients that presently conduct the breath testing have their own devices on board the vessel and the test is also conducted by the Ship staff, so our collector only has to take down the readings.
- Necessary instruction will be provided on mail in details about the breath testing.
- Please sure to contact us in case of any queries prior boarding.

Instructions for unannounced visit on board

- As per our initial request, please note this is an **Unannounced** D&A Test, therefore the vessel should not be informed about the collector visit prior boarding. Please instruct the agents as well that the vessel should not be aware of his visit.
- Once on board, the collector needs to hand-in some documents i.e., Letter to Master/Client Permission letter' and 'Authorization to the Collector' to the Master/PIC available on board, which will suffice our purpose of visit on board.
- Request the Master to provide an updated crew list of the vessel
- Request to assign a Senior ship staff as a witness for the collection.
- Allocate the hospital or clinic whichever is available on board which has an attached washroom.

On board preparation for Collection

- Prepare the area for collection purpose, inspect the washroom make sure all the water inlets are sealed, which means the crew cannot get access to water while providing sample.
- Instruct the Master/Senior staff, to send one crew at a time for testing, Donors should carry their passport/ID for identification purpose and medicines (regular prescribed or any type anti-biotics) as the same needs to be mentioned on the forms for lab reference.
- Assigned Staff/ship witness should be all time present with the collector during the whole process for witnessing the Test.
- Containers should be all time present in the collector view, no containers should be given out of the collection area. (donors should submit the samples in witness on the collector and assigned staff only)

Urine Sampling process

- Samples can be collected from the crew members randomly or in any order, on basis of the crew availability.
- One crew member should enter the collection area for sampling at a time.
- In case, any crew member is not able to provide the sample, instruct them to drink lot of water and return for sample after 15-20 mins again.
- While providing the samples the crew members should face towards the door and the washroom door cannot be locked/to be kept open. However, in case of female crew the door should be closed while providing the sample.
- After providing the samples, the container to be sealed and donor to countersign on the seal. Make sure all the details are filled on the DATF for the individual crew and signed by all parties (Crew, assigned staff & Collector.
- Please collect the samples from all the crew members present on board as per the vessel crew list.
- After completion, make sure all the samples collected are in order and all forms to attach with them to avoid any miss out, take a count prior disembarking.
- Provide one copy of DATFs for the individual donors or scan copies of MOUs upon completion of the collection for their records. Also one copy of Signed/stamped Letter to Master as well as a provisional letter until the reports are been released.

Hair Sampling - Process

- The donor's hair should be cut near the rear of the crown and as close to the scalp as possible. The lab requires approximately 120 strands for testing. If all the hairs are placed side by side, this equates to a half inch of hair.
- It is recommended that hair collection occur on several different areas across the crown of the head to avoid creating bald spots.
- If the donor has little or no hair, or head hair is less than a half inch long, a body hair collection may be conducted e.g., chest, underarm, leg, or face.
- Place the hair specimen in the foil, root end extending out, approximately a quarter of an inch from the slanted end of the foil.
- Remove the security seal from the DATF and place it on the bottom of the specimen envelope where indicated.
- Staple both the DAT form and sealed Envelope for respective donors for easy identification at our Lab.
- Please refer the Hair testing Procedure send along with the other documents, in case of hair sample testing. Let us know in case of any queries for sampling.

Prior disembarkation

- Once the sampling is completed, the collector has be take a count of the total samples collected as per the crew list are in order.
- All the forms are properly filled, signed by each parties.
- Letter to Master to document is been signed by the Master with the vessel stamp.
- For the vessel records one copy of the Letter to Master document and one copy of DATF or scan copies of the MOU forms (individual donor) to be left on board.
- Prior disembarking, we need to make sure all the samples with the necessary documents are been properly packed and taken.

Post Completion

- Once back from the vessel, we request to revert with the scan copies of the DATF or MOU forms for our internal records, in case of any leakage we have a copies always available at our end.
- We request to take a picture of the sample taken and also before/after packing for records purpose.
- Share the shipping address in order to arrange for FedEx/DHL AWB as well pick up, accordingly we shall make the arrangements as well send the necessary shipping documents for the same.
- We request to take a shipment receipt preferably signed by the DHL/FedEx representative as well a photo with the DHL representative to ensure the pick up was done, as sometimes due to remote areas or third party the shipment takes more time for connectively than usual.
- Please share the Collection invoice once the collection is completed.

Packing instructions – as per IATA guidelines

- Use a cardboard box that is as per the number of samples neither too big or too small.
- Ensure that the caps of the vials are secured hand tight to ensure no leakage /spillage of specimens while in transit.
- Also kindly use the polythene zip pouch bags provided by us for the dispatch of vials, place each vial labelled and sealed in the individual zip lock polythene bag.
- Use an absorbent i.e tissue to be added in the box to absorb the specimen, if there is a leakage while in transit.
- Please specify on the box that it is 'Non infectious exempt human specimen'.
- Soft copies of the crew mou, letter to master, crew list etc to be scanned and sent to us on med@trustshipping.org hardcopies to be dispatched in with the samples properly sealed in a plastic bag to avoid any damage due to the spillage of the urine.